

POST-WAR TANKS

After 1945, a new class of armoured fighting tank or vehicle evolved: the Main Battle Tank (MBT), which was more heavily armoured, had a more powerful engine, and was armed with a more potent gun than its World War II predecessors. Although light and medium tanks were still manufactured, it was the MBT that dominated tank production and tactics. The major design development in this period was the introduction of new armour types. Conventional steel armour had become vulnerable to high-explosive anti-tank (HEAT) projectiles, and, to solve this problem, composite armours were introduced, of which the composite Chobham type, used on the Challenger and Abrams tanks, was the best known.



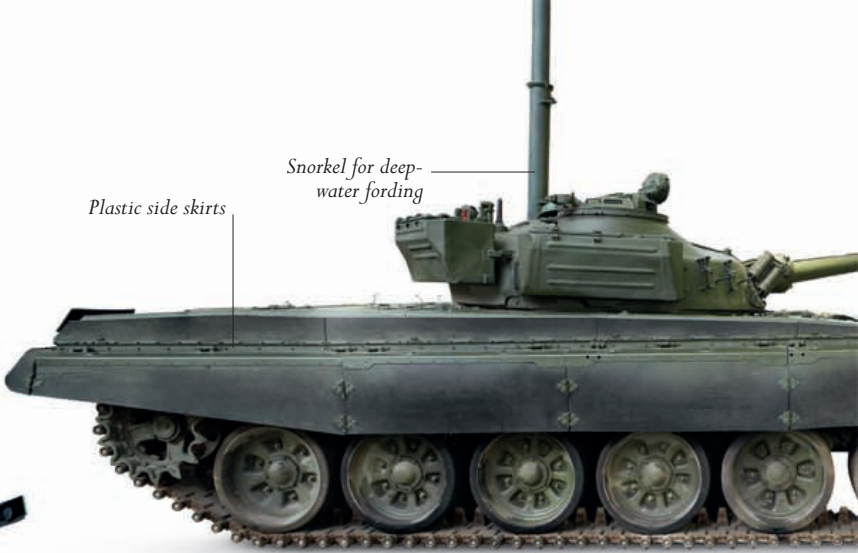
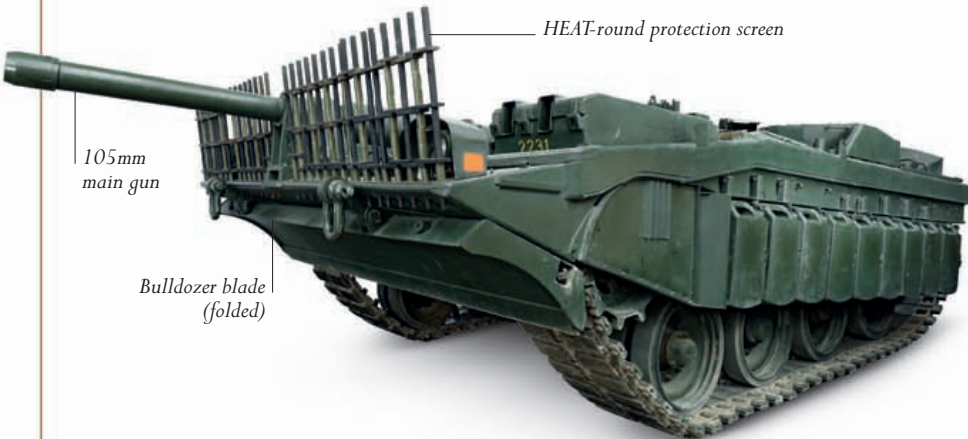
► **T62**
Date 1961 **Origin** Soviet Union
Weight 40 tonnes (44 tons)
Length 6.63m (21¾ft)
Top speed 50kph (31mph)
Engine V-55 12-cylinder 433kW (581hp) diesel engine

A development from the T55, the T62 was equipped with infrared night-vision equipment. It was operated by a crew of four men: the commander, driver, gunner, and loader. It was the first modern tank to be armed with a smoothbore main gun.



▼ **STRIDSVAGN 103**
Date 1966 **Origin** Sweden
Weight 39 tonnes (42.9 tons)
Length 9m (29½ft)
Top speed 50kph (31mph)
Engine Rolls-Royce 223kW (490hp) diesel/Caterpillar gas turbine engine

Often known as the S-Tank, this radical turret-less tank was armed with a fixed gun that was traversed by engaging the left or right tracks, and elevated by adjusting the hull suspension. It was operated by three crew.



▲ **T72**
Date 1971 **Origin** Soviet Union
Weight 41.5 tonnes (45.7 tons)
Length 6.95m (22¾ft)
Top speed 60kph (37mph)
Engine 12-cylinder 582kW (780hp) diesel engine

The three-man T72 was an effective, if not particularly advanced, tank that dispensed with the usual fourth crew member in favour of an automatic loader. It was widely exported to countries around the world.

◀ **AMX-13**
Date 1952 **Origin** France
Weight 14.5 tonnes (15.9 tons)
Length 4.88m (16ft)
Top speed 60kph (37mph)
Engine Model 8Gxb 8-cylinder 190kW (250hp) petrol engine

Developed as an air-portable light tank to support airborne forces, the AMX-13 featured an unusual two-part turret and an automatic loading system with two six-round magazines. It was manned by three crew.

